

Questions & Answers

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Highlighted fields are to be filled in with real numbers and details.

MAIN QUESTIONS

1. Tell me about yourself

I'm an engineer by training. I studied [engineering and robotics at X], and that taught me to break problems down and look at data before opinions.

For the last five years I've been the General Manager of West Auto, our family-owned dealership in [city], here in North-East Romania. I'm responsible for the whole business: sourcing, sales, financing, deliveries and after-sales, with a team of [X] people. Last year we sold [X] cars, and [X]% of them were electric or hybrid, because we moved into EVs early. In 2022 I sold a Model X when nobody in our region was selling Teslas.

What I'm proudest of is the team: today my people handle financing, deliveries and difficult customers on their own.

Tesla is now opening in Iași, and I want to bring my local market knowledge and hands-on leadership to build this store from day one, this time at scale and with Tesla's processes behind me.

2. Why Tesla?

Three reasons.

First, I've seen the mission happen with my own customers. In 2022 I brought in a Model X when nobody here was selling Teslas. I had to answer every question myself: range, charging, winters in Moldova. That customer became one of my happiest. Since then EV demand has grown every year. Today about [X] out of 10 people who walk into our showroom ask about electric first.

Second, the timing. Tesla is opening its first location in Iași. I know this market: the customers, the local businesses, how people here buy and finance cars. Helping launch it is a once-in-a-career opportunity.

Third, the way Tesla sells. Transparent prices, no haggling, everything focused on the experience. That's how I've always wanted to sell.

The global transition happens locally: in a store, one test drive at a time. I want to lead that here.

3. Why move from your own business to a corporate role?

Running a family business taught me to own every part of the result, because there's nobody else to blame. But it has a natural ceiling: [X] people, one location, limited processes and data.

At Tesla I can apply that same ownership at a much bigger scale: a bigger team to develop, processes tested across hundreds of stores, and a mission I believe in.

I also know what changes. At Tesla I won't set prices or decide which cars to buy, and I'm comfortable with that. The levers I care about most are the ones a supervisor has: the team, the customer experience and execution. Honestly, I'm looking forward to having a manager I can learn from.

FOLLOW-UP “What happens with West Auto?”

[My father/brother] is taking over day-to-day management. I'll have no operational role, and I'm happy to declare it formally under Tesla's conflict-of-interest policy. If I join Tesla, I'm 100% Tesla.

FOLLOW-UP “Why didn't you take your business to the next level?”

Fair question. Within its model, we did grow it: from [X] cars a year when I took over to [Y] today, and we moved into EVs before anyone else in our area.

But an independent dealer has a natural ceiling. We depend on imports, we carry all the stock with our own money, and we don't have a brand behind us. The next level would have meant [taking on significant debt / opening new locations / becoming a franchise dealer]. As a family, we decided not to take that risk. It was a shared decision, not just mine.

Honestly, it made me clear about what I want. What I enjoy most isn't buying and selling stock as an owner. It's leading a team and building a great customer experience, and I believe the future is electric. For me, the next level isn't a bigger dealership. It's doing what I do best at Tesla's scale, in the company that's leading that change.

FOLLOW-UP “Won't you go back to it, or start your own business again?”

No. This is a deliberate career decision, not a break. [Family member] runs West Auto now, and I'm joining Tesla to build something here for the long term.

4. Underperforming team member

S: One of the sales advisors on my team had plenty of traffic, about [X] test drives a month, but closed only [X]%, against a team average of [Y]%.

T: I wanted to find out *why*, not just tell him to sell more.

A: I went through his lost deals and sat in on a few customer conversations. The pattern was clear: customers lost confidence when financing came up (interest rates, bank requirements, credit scoring). I coached him one-on-one on real cases and role-played the objections with him. Then I enrolled him in a specialised training with tbi bank. We agreed on a clear goal and checked progress every week.

R: Within [X weeks] his conversion went from [X]% to [Y]%. Today he handles all financing and leasing files on his own.

Learning: Underperformance is usually a skill or confidence gap, not a motivation problem. Diagnose it with data, then coach the specific gap.

FOLLOW-UP “What if coaching hadn't worked?”

I'd set a written improvement plan with clear, measurable goals and a timeline, and keep supporting him. If there was still no progress, I'd involve my manager and HR. Being fair to him also means being fair to the rest of the team.

5. Day-to-day management & motivation

I lead from the floor, not from the office.

- **Morning huddle, 10 minutes:** yesterday's numbers, today's test drives and deliveries, who does what, possible bottlenecks.
- **During the day:** I'm with the team. I listen to conversations, give feedback on the spot, and step in when it gets busy. My goal is to make people independent, not to do their job for them.
- **Weekly:** a short 1:1 with everyone on their numbers *and* their development.

Motivation comes from three things. **Clear goals**, so everyone knows what winning looks like. **Recognition:** I call out good work in front of the team. **Growth:** the advisor I coached on financing is now our go-to person for it. At Tesla there's a fourth one, the mission. People who feel part of something bigger don't need to be pushed.

6. Conflict with a colleague

S: In a busy week with [X] deliveries, I disagreed with [our preparation lead] on which cars to prepare first. He worked in order of arrival; I wanted the cars for the earliest customer appointments first.

A: Instead of pulling rank, I took him aside, listened, and we went through the schedule together. It turned out he didn't have the updated customer arrival times. The problem was information, not attitude.

R: All [X] cars were delivered on time. We then created a shared delivery schedule, [updated daily in X], so sales and preparation see the same priorities. We haven't had that conflict since.

Learning: Most conflicts in a store are information problems, not people problems.

7. Making sure the team follows procedures

I explain the *why*. When people understand that a procedure protects the customer or the brand, they follow it. I follow every standard myself and do short spot checks.

Example: [At West Auto we introduced a pre-delivery checklist of X points. After that, complaints about Y dropped by Z.]

The first time someone cuts a corner, it's a coaching moment. If it happens again, it becomes a clear conversation with consequences. Being consistent is fair to the people who *do* follow the rules.

At Tesla, processes change often. When something new comes in, the team should hear it from me in the morning huddle, understand why it changed, and I check in the first week that it's applied. That's how change actually sticks.

8. Managing targets & KPIs (the Tesla funnel)

I manage KPIs as a funnel: **opportunities created → test drives → orders → pre-delivery readiness → deliveries → customer satisfaction**. I track it daily, share it in the morning huddle, and break the monthly and quarterly target into weekly goals per person.

When a number drops, I look for the bottleneck, not for someone to blame. **Example:** one advisor had lots of test drives but few orders, so the problem was conversion, not traffic. Sitting in on his follow-ups, I saw [he wasn't following up within 24 hours / couldn't answer financing questions]. We fixed that specific gap, and [result].

At Tesla I'd watch **pre-delivery readiness** very closely, especially at quarter end. If financing, payment and documents aren't ready before delivery day, you lose deliveries you've already sold.

For me, KPIs are a diagnostic tool, not a punishment.

9. A time you missed a target

S: In [month/year] an import delay left us with [X] cars instead of [Y], and we missed the monthly target by [X]%.

T: I owned it. Planning for that risk was my job.

A: Short term, I focused the team on what we could control: converting every lead on the cars we had, following up every open offer within 24 hours, and using financing and trade-in options to make decisions easier. Long term, I fixed the root cause: [a second supplier / ordering with an X-week buffer].

R: The next month we sold [X] cars, [X]% above target, and we haven't had a gap like that since.

Tesla link: It's like quarter end when ships arrive late. You can't create more cars, but you can make sure every customer is ready on delivery day so that no delivery slips.

10. Coaching someone through a difficult sale

Battery degradation is the objection I hear most. When an advisor gets stuck, I join the conversation, not to take over but to show another approach. Instead of saying "don't worry", I use facts: the 8-year battery and drive-unit warranty, Tesla's published degradation data, and if it helps, the real battery health of [a 5-year-old car we sold]. Then I let the advisor finish the sale.

Afterwards we debrief for five minutes: what worked and what to say next time. The next time, he handles it alone. My goal is never to be the closer. It's to make every advisor able to close.

11. Difficult / dissatisfied customer

S: A customer's car broke down [X weeks] after purchase, and he filed a complaint with ANPC, the national consumer protection authority, before we even knew about the problem.

T: I took ownership. My goal was to restore his trust and fix it fast.

A: I called him personally, first to listen and apologise, then to explain exactly what would happen and when. I arranged the pickup, got an expedited service slot within two days, and gave him a loaner car so he didn't lose his mobility. I updated him every [two days] until it was solved.

R: The car was fixed in five days. He wrote to ANPC himself to confirm the case had been handled very well, and later he referred one of his relatives to us.

Learning: He went to ANPC because he didn't know who to call. After that we [introduced a follow-up call X days after every delivery / gave every customer one direct contact person].

At Tesla this is the Sales-Service collaboration in the job description. The customer doesn't care which department owns the problem. They care that *someone* owns it.

12. Going above and beyond

S: A customer needed his car for a family trip that weekend, but on Friday afternoon the bank's financing approval was still blocked.

A: Instead of saying "Monday", I called the loan officer, found out exactly which document was missing, got it from the customer, and drove to the branch myself. Then I stayed after hours to do the handover properly: a full walkthrough, not a rushed one.

R: He left for his trip on time and has since referred [X] customers.

Learning: Delivery day is the moment customers remember. At Tesla I'd want to catch issues like that days earlier, with pre-delivery readiness checks, so nobody needs heroics on a Friday afternoon.

13. Balancing sales numbers and customer experience

I believe they're the same thing. Numbers come from referrals and repeat customers, and you only get those with a great experience. I never let my team push a car that doesn't fit the customer's needs. An aggressive sale helps this month and damages the brand for years.

At Tesla it's even cleaner. The price is the price, so the advisor's whole job is to help the customer choose the right car. I'd look at customer satisfaction next to conversion. If an advisor converts well but scores low on satisfaction, that's a coaching conversation too.

14. A typical day as Store Supervisor

- **Before opening:** yesterday's numbers and today's plan (test drives, deliveries, who's in). A walk through the store: showroom, demo cars charged and clean, delivery area ready. Then a 10-minute huddle.
- **Peak hours:** on the floor, supporting advisors, taking escalations, joining deliveries.
- **Quieter hours:** pre-delivery readiness for upcoming deliveries, follow-ups, coordination with Service, reporting to the Country Lead.
- **End of day:** five minutes with the team on what's open for tomorrow.

At quarter end the day looks completely different. Deliveries come first, and I plan staffing weeks in advance.

15. Prioritising several urgent issues

My rule is simple: first the customer in front of me, then whatever affects customers today, then everything else.

Example: if a customer is waiting for a delivery and at the same time we have a logistics problem, I handle the handover myself. I give the logistics issue to one person with a clear task and deadline, "get me X by 3 pm", then take over as soon as I'm free. Delegating with a clear owner is what lets you handle two fires at once.

16. Adapting to a major market shift

S: A few years ago our business was mostly diesel and petrol. Around [year] I saw interest in EVs growing among our customers.

A: I changed our purchasing strategy and started bringing in EVs like the Model 3 and Model Y. The harder part was bringing the team along: some advisors were comfortable with diesels and nervous about EV questions. So [we drove the EVs ourselves / I wrote a list of the 20 most common EV questions with answers / we did training on charging].

R: EVs and hybrids went from [X]% of our sales in [year] to [Y]% in [year], and the team now sells them confidently.

Learning: Change doesn't stick because the leader decides it. It sticks when the team feels confident in the new way.

MORE LIKELY QUESTIONS

A. “How would you grow Tesla in Iași? / How would you build awareness for a new store?”

Tesla doesn't rely on classic advertising, so growth comes from **test drives, referrals and community**. In Iași I'd focus on four things:

1. **Existing owners in the region.** Today they drive to [Bacău/Bucharest] for service. They're our best ambassadors, so I'd invite them to the opening and use the referral program.
2. **Companies.** Iași has a big IT, medical and university community, and many cars here are bought through companies and leasing. Test-drive days at large employers' offices, plus clear explanations of company purchase and leasing.
3. **Test drives everywhere.** Local events, shopping centres, [specific local events you know].
4. **Financing education.** Rabla, the current Tesla offers and leasing explained simply. That's where many customers here get stuck, and it's my strongest skill.

B. “How would you hire and build your team from scratch?”

I hire for **attitude and coachability**, because product and process can be taught. I look for customer empathy, energy, curiosity about technology, integrity (no pushy selling) and resilience for quarter end. In the interview I'd include a short role-play with a "customer".

Some of the best advisors don't come from car sales. They come from hospitality, tech retail or customer service. I want a diverse team where everyone feels respected and can grow. Then structured onboarding: product, processes, shadowing deliveries, and a 30-day check-in.

C. “At Tesla prices are fixed. A customer asks for a discount. What do you do?”

Honestly, I see fixed pricing as an advantage. In a dealership a lot of energy goes into negotiation; at Tesla it goes into the experience. I move the conversation from price to **value and total cost**: running costs vs fuel, the current Tesla offers, Rabla, leasing options, over-the-air updates, the warranty, the Supercharger network. And every customer gets the same fair price, which builds trust.

D. “What's your biggest weakness?”

Because I ran a small business, my reflex when the store gets busy is to do things myself. I've learned that a leader who does everything creates a team that can't work without him. So I now delegate on purpose. Financing, for example, is fully handled by [colleague]. I measure myself by how well the store runs when I'm *not* there.

E. “What would you do in your first 90 days?”

- **Days 1-30, learn:** Tesla's processes and systems, time with other Romanian stores, meeting the team one-on-one, mapping the local market.
- **Days 31-60, launch:** test-drive events, owners community, company test days, a daily KPI routine with the team, first delivery waves done perfectly.
- **Days 61-90, optimise:** compare our funnel with other Romanian stores, fix the biggest bottleneck, identify the future leaders in the team.

F. Situational: “It's the last week of the quarter: [40] deliveries, two advisors are sick. What do you do?”

First, protect the deliveries. Check pre-delivery readiness for every customer: payment, financing, documents. Anything not ready, I call personally today. Re-plan the schedule: group deliveries in waves, ask for support from the delivery team or another store if possible, and take deliveries myself. I communicate proactively with any customer whose slot changes. Then, after the quarter, a short review: what could we have prepared earlier?

G. “Where do you see yourself in 3 years?”

Running a high-performing store in Iași, and having developed at least one person from my team into a supervisor. After that, I'm open to a bigger role in the region, wherever I can have the most impact.

H. “Who are our competitors here?”

In Iași the competition comes from three directions. **Chinese brands**, led by BYD, which are growing fast in Romania. **Established EVs** such as the VW ID. family, Skoda Enyaq, Hyundai and Kia, plus Dacia Spring at the entry level. And the **used-EV import market**, which I know from the inside.

Tesla's advantage against all of them is the complete package: the product, the Supercharger network, over-the-air updates and Tesla's own service. I'd make sure every advisor can explain that in two minutes.